Positive assumption lowers threat without removing accountability.

- Assume a reasonable reason, not a perfect motive.
- Name the observable issue without adding a blame story.
- Invite correction quickly: “If that’s off, correct me.”
- Move to a concrete next step; do not stay in warm framing.

Minimum viable move: “I’m assuming there’s a reasonable reason. Can you walk me through it?”

TC060 / Positive assumption
Top500 rank 60

Use when intent is unclear, facts matter, and blame would make honesty harder.

Avoid when there is immediate risk, repeated harm, coercion, discrimination, or impact needs naming first.

Neighbour check This is not similarity signalling, status generosity, or validation without agreement. It is a benign interpretation before inquiry or correction.

Recovery “Let me correct that. I do not know your intent; I can name the impact more clearly.”

Autonomy rule: use this to increase clarity and respect, not to pressure or override autonomy.